

Jury Data Report

Statewide Metrics on Jury Operations

Judicial Council of California

2026-04-15

Table of contents

Introduction	2
Definitions	2
Jury Summoning Process	2
Reasons for Juror Unavailability	2
Jury Utilization and Selection	3
Jury Trial Types and Designations	3
Jury Yield	3
Available, Unavailable and Yield Trends	3
Unavailable Jurors by Subcategory	5
Jury Utilization	5
Figure 3.5: Distribution of Key Measures by Court (2025)	6
Figure 4: Panel Distribution by Case Type	7
Figure 5: Panel Case Types — Historical Trend	8
Figure 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type	9
Figure 7: Sworn Case Types — Historical Trend	10
Figure 8: One-Day Jury Service by Modality	11
Figure 9: One-Day Service Modality — Historical Trend	12
Tables	13
Table 1: Jury Yield Summary (2016–Present)	13
Table 2: Juror Yield Summary by Year	14
Table 3: Unavailable Juror Subcategories	14
Table 4: Utilization Pipeline Summary	14
Table 5: Panel Distribution by Case Type	14
Table 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type	15
Table 7: One-Day Jury Service by Modality	15

Introduction

Since fiscal year 2007, the Judicial Council of California has administered an opt-in survey to each California trial court to collect operational data on jury department performance. The survey captures metrics aligned with the National Center for Court Studies' (NCSC) 8th Trial Court Performance Measure on the Effective Use of Jurors. Courts use these metrics to streamline juror summons and qualification and to increase the rate at which they seat juries from the available pool of prospective jurors.

This report summarizes statewide jury metrics for the most recent reporting year and presents ten-year historical trends. It provides a comprehensive overview of jury summoning outcomes, juror availability, case type distributions, and the effectiveness of the jury selection pipeline across California's superior courts. The Judicial Council intends for these findings to support more efficient jury operations statewide and to better meet the demands of modern jury service.

Definitions

Jury Summoning Process

NEWLY SUMMONED. The total number of prospective jurors who received a summons to appear for jury duty, whether by mail, electronic service, or other means. This figure represents the initial pool of potential jurors contacted by trial courts.

POSTPONED IN. Prospective jurors from a prior-period who had postponed their service to the current period, and are hence summoned for service in the current period in lieu of their prior-period obligation.

TOTAL SUMMONED. The total amount of jurors summoned for jury duty in the current period; the summation of Newly Summoned and Postponed In.

QUALIFIED AND AVAILABLE. Prospective jurors who appear for jury duty, meet all statutory and court-imposed qualifications for service, and are available for potential jury selection. These individuals have passed initial screening and remain eligible for assignment to trials.

Reasons for Juror Unavailability

EXCUSED. Prospective jurors who are released from jury duty due to hardship or other compelling personal reasons. Excused jurors may be excused for a single trial or for an extended period.

DISQUALIFIED. Prospective jurors who do not meet the statutory requirements for jury service, including citizenship, language proficiency, or freedom from felony conviction.

DISMISSED. Prospective jurors who are removed from jury duty by judicial order, either due to peace officer involvement or death.

UNDELIVERED. Summonses that could not be delivered to the prospective juror due to incorrect address, inability to locate the individual, or refusal of service.

FAILURE TO APPEAR. Prospective jurors who received a valid summons but did not appear on their scheduled date without authorization.

POSTPONED OUT. Prospective jurors whose service is postponed to a future date after their initial scheduled appearance or who request postponement and are granted relief to a later period.

Jury Utilization and Selection

TOLD TO REPORT. The percentage of summoned prospective jurors who are instructed to physically appear for jury duty. Not all summoned jurors are called to report; many complete their service by simply waiting on-call or on stand-by.

SENT FOR SELECTION. The percentage of prospective jurors told to report who are actually sent to a courtroom for jury selection proceedings. Some may be released or dismissed prior to reaching the selection phase.

PANEL USED. The percentage of prospective jurors sent for selection who are ultimately assigned to a jury panel, either sworn or released during or after jury selection. This represents the final stage of the jury utilization pipeline.

Jury Trial Types and Designations

FELONY, MISDEMEANOR, CIVIL, AND OTHER. Case types distinguish the nature of the matter being tried. Felony cases involve serious criminal offenses; misdemeanor cases involve lesser criminal offenses; civil cases involve disputes between private parties or entities; and other cases include specialized proceedings.

ONE-DAY JURORS. Qualified and Available jurors who finish their service in one day, whether it be on call, on standby, or in person are considered one-day jurors. In-person designations indicate physical courtroom appearance, while teleconference designations indicate remote participation.

Jury Yield

Available, Unavailable and Yield Trends

California statewide jury summons outcomes, FY2021–FY2025

Table 1: Jury Yield Summary

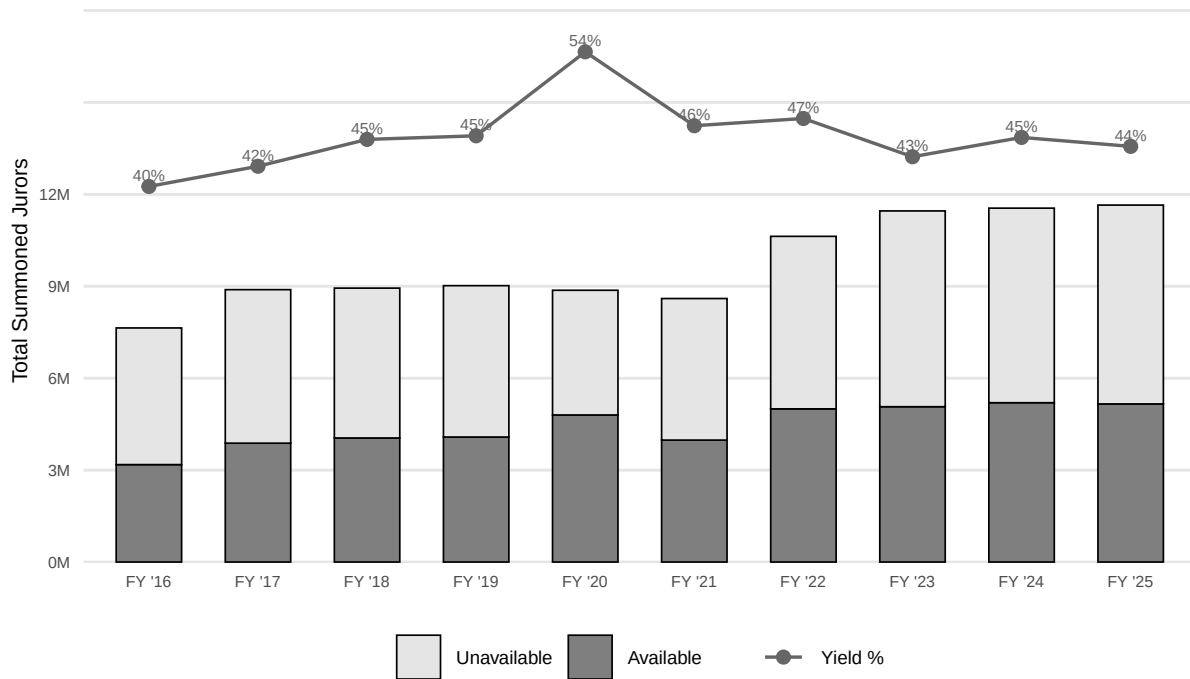


Figure 1: Jury Yield Trends

Total summoned jurors have reached nearly 12 million each year since FY '23. Both available and unavailable jurors increased post-2020, while yield has remained stable. While the number of jurors summoned has increased, the percentage of those jurors who are qualified and available has not changed significantly, indicating that the increase in summons has not translated into a higher yield of usable jurors.

Unavailable Jurors by Subcategory

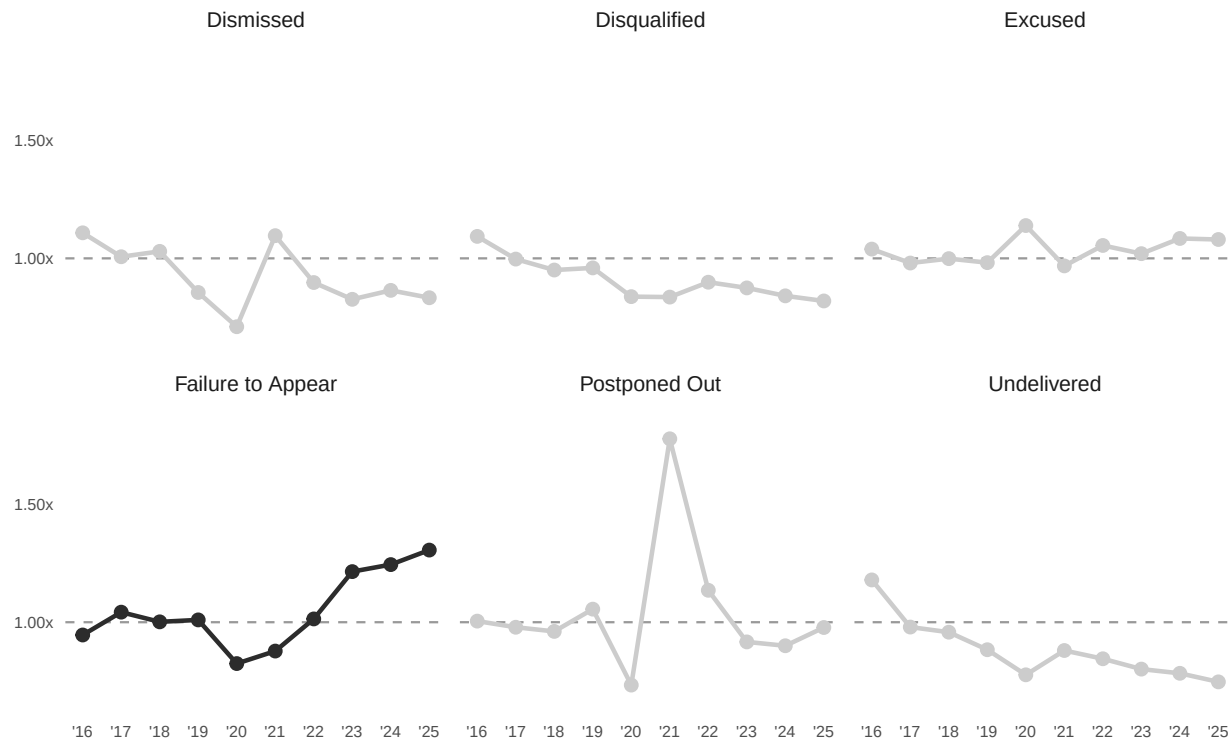


Figure 2: Unavailable Jurors by Subcategory

Indexed line chart showing changes in unavailable juror subcategories (excused, disqualified, dismissed, undelivered, failure to appear, and postponed out) relative to average value of pre-2020 baseline.

Jury Utilization

Percentage of summoned jurors at each stage, California statewide

Bar chart showing the percentage of summoned prospective jurors who progress through the jury utilization pipeline: told to report, sent for selection, and ultimately used in a panel.

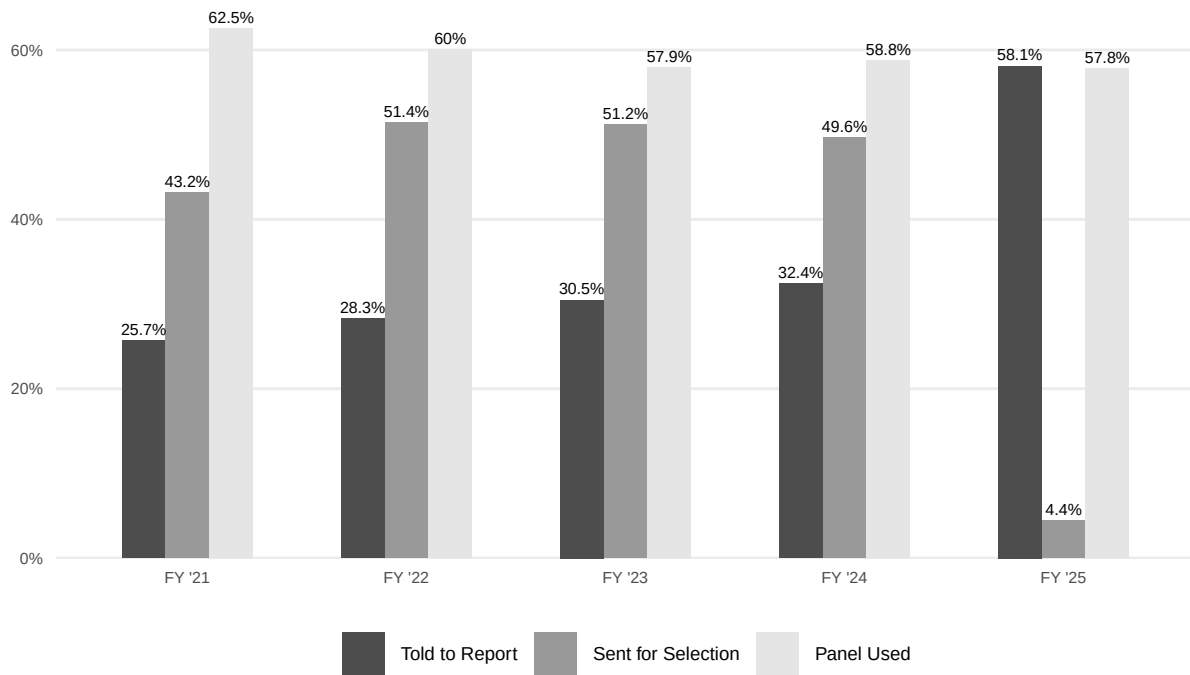


Figure 3: Jury Utilization Pipeline

Figure 3.5: Distribution of Key Measures by Court (2025)

California by Court, FY 2025

Box and whisker plot showing the distribution of three key measures across all California courts: told to report, sent for selection, and panel used. Each point represents an individual court.

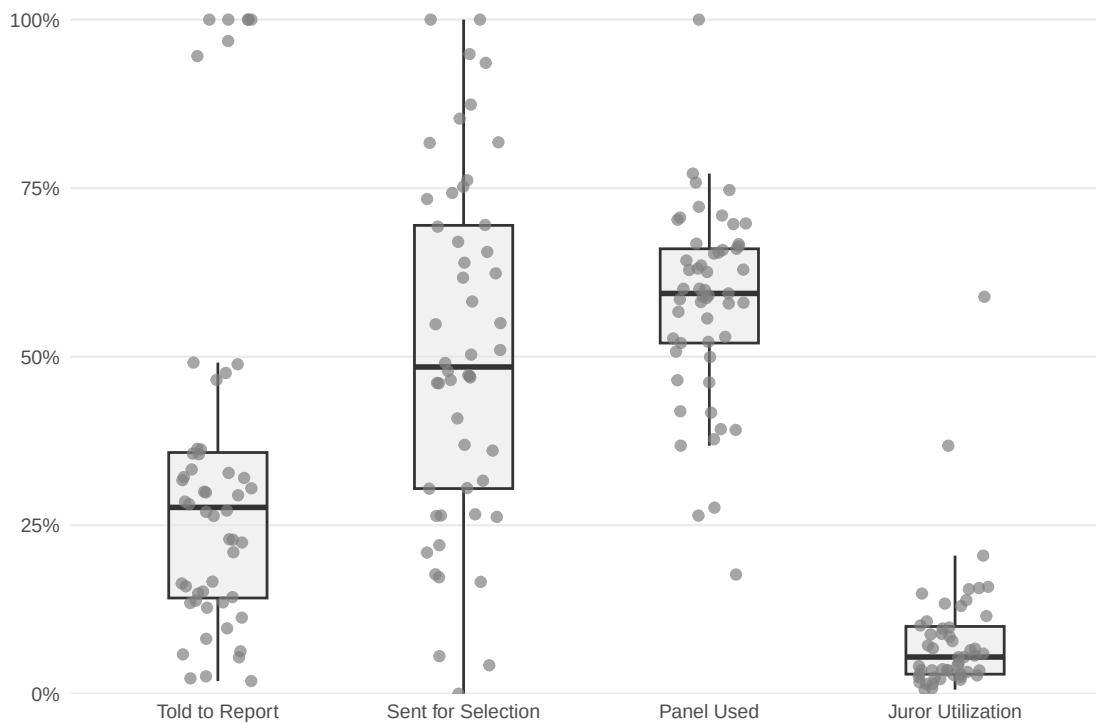


Figure 3.5: Distribution by Court

Figure 4: Panel Distribution by Case Type

California statewide, FY25

Bar chart showing the distribution of prospective jurors sent for selection by case type (felony, misdemeanor, civil, and other) in the most recent fiscal year.

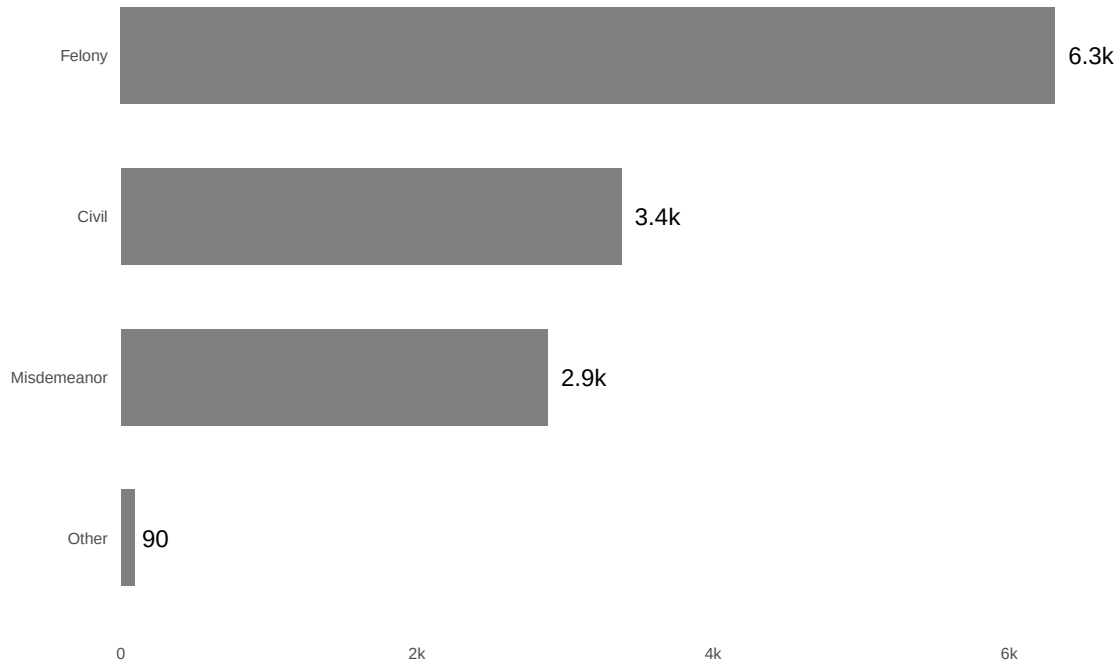


Figure 4: Panel Distribution by Case Type

Figure 5: Panel Case Types — Historical Trend

Indexed line chart showing the trend in panel composition by case type from FY2021 baseline across the past five fiscal years.

1.0 = FY2021 baseline · values above 1.0 indicate growth from baseline

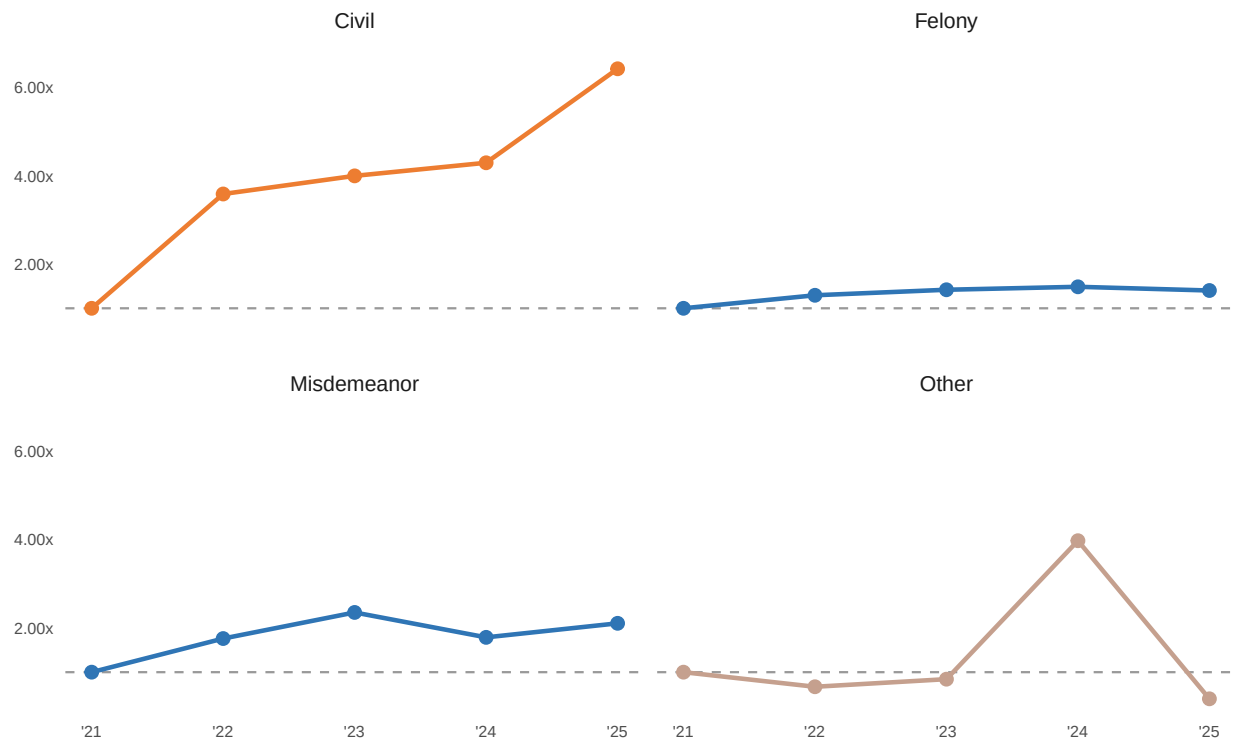


Figure 5: Panel Case Types Historical Trend

Figure 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type

Bar chart showing the count of sworn jurors by case type (felony, misdemeanor, civil, and other) in the most recent fiscal year.

California statewide, FY25

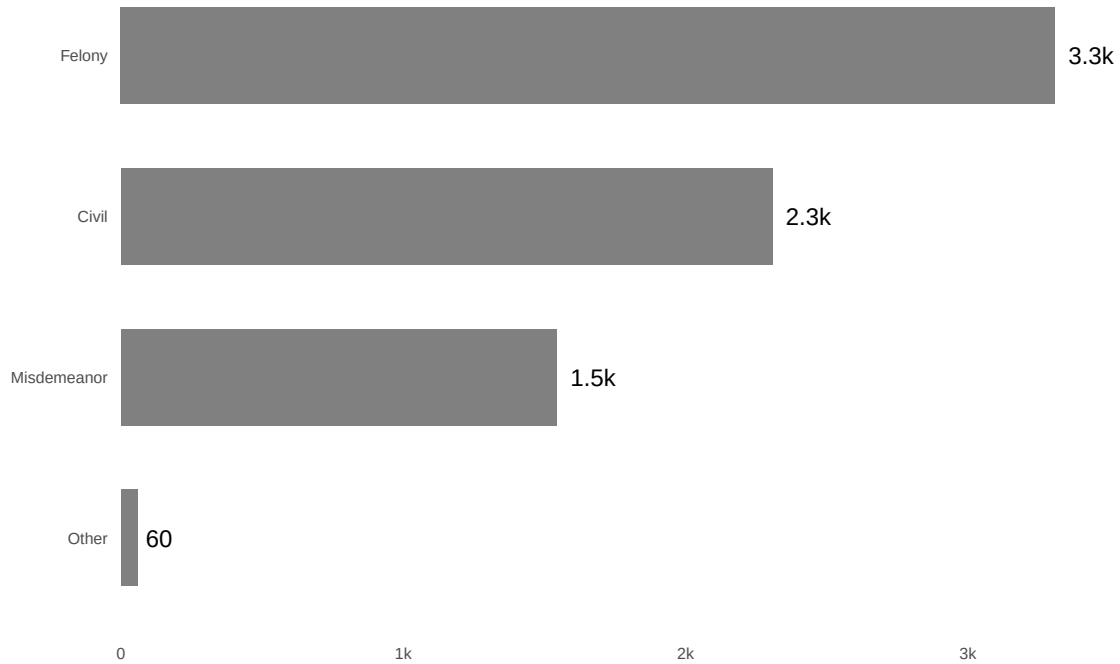


Figure 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type

Figure 7: Sworn Case Types — Historical Trend

Indexed line chart showing the trend in sworn jurors by case type from FY2021 baseline across the past five fiscal years.

1.0 = FY2021 baseline · values above 1.0 indicate growth from baseline

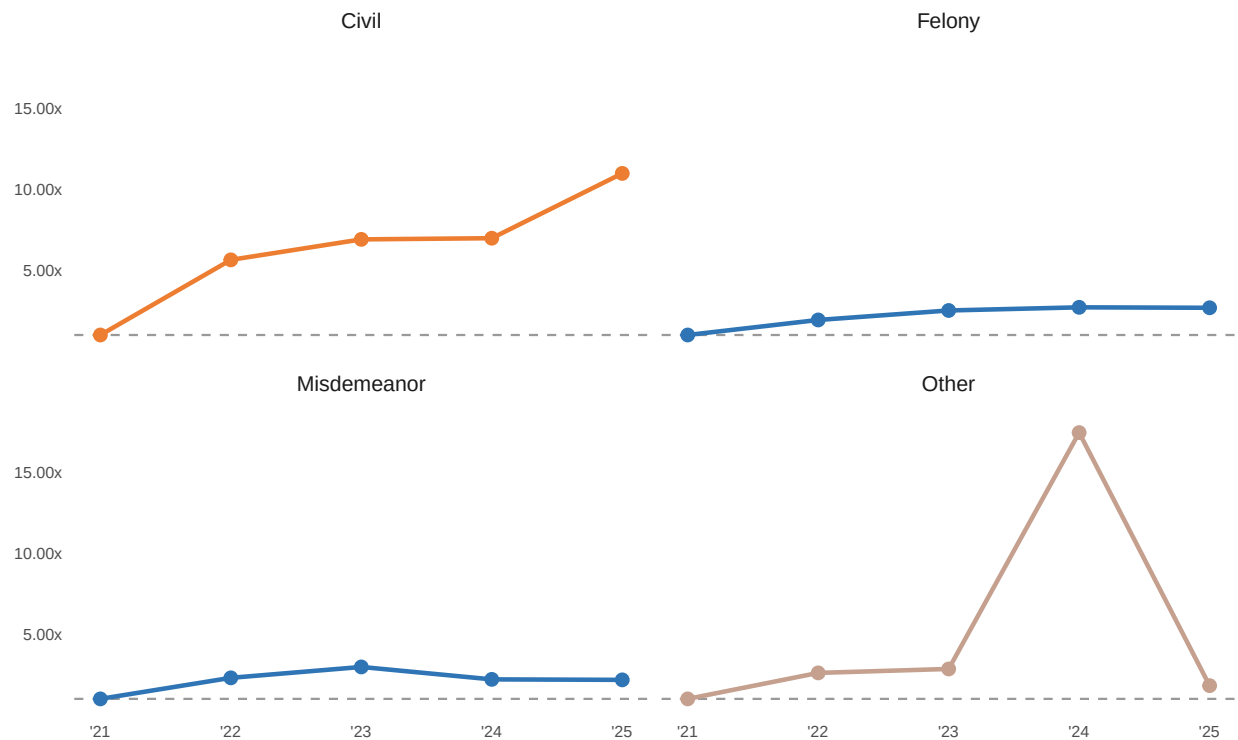


Figure 7: Sworn Case Types Historical Trend

Figure 8: One-Day Jury Service by Modality

Bar chart showing the count of one-day jurors by modality (in-person and teleconference) in the most recent fiscal year.

California statewide, FY25

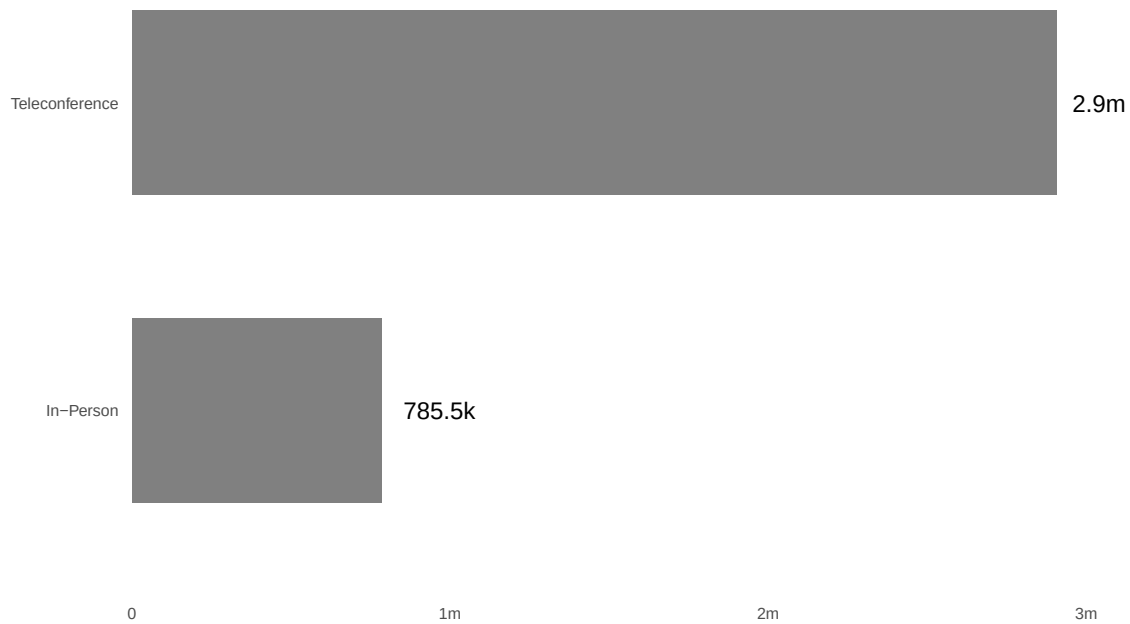


Figure 8: One-Day Jury Service by Modality

Figure 9: One-Day Service Modality — Historical Trend

Indexed line chart showing the trend in one-day jury service by modality from FY2021 baseline across the past five fiscal years.

1.0 = FY2021 baseline · values above 1.0 indicate growth from baseline

Fiscal Year	Total Summoned	Available	Unavailable	Yield %
FY '25	11,693,050	5,155,919	6,488,247	44.1
FY '24	11,549,532	5,201,478	6,348,054	45.0
FY '23	11,806,037	5,074,893	6,387,714	43.0
FY '22	10,630,992	5,001,376	5,629,616	47.0
FY '21	8,676,109	3,980,194	4,620,327	46.3
FY '20	8,876,300	4,803,482	4,072,818	54.1
FY '19	9,399,625	4,078,861	4,942,656	45.2
FY '18	9,382,375	4,050,135	4,894,952	44.8
FY '17	9,238,325	3,878,192	5,012,346	42.0
FY '16	7,978,849	3,178,589	4,459,101	39.8

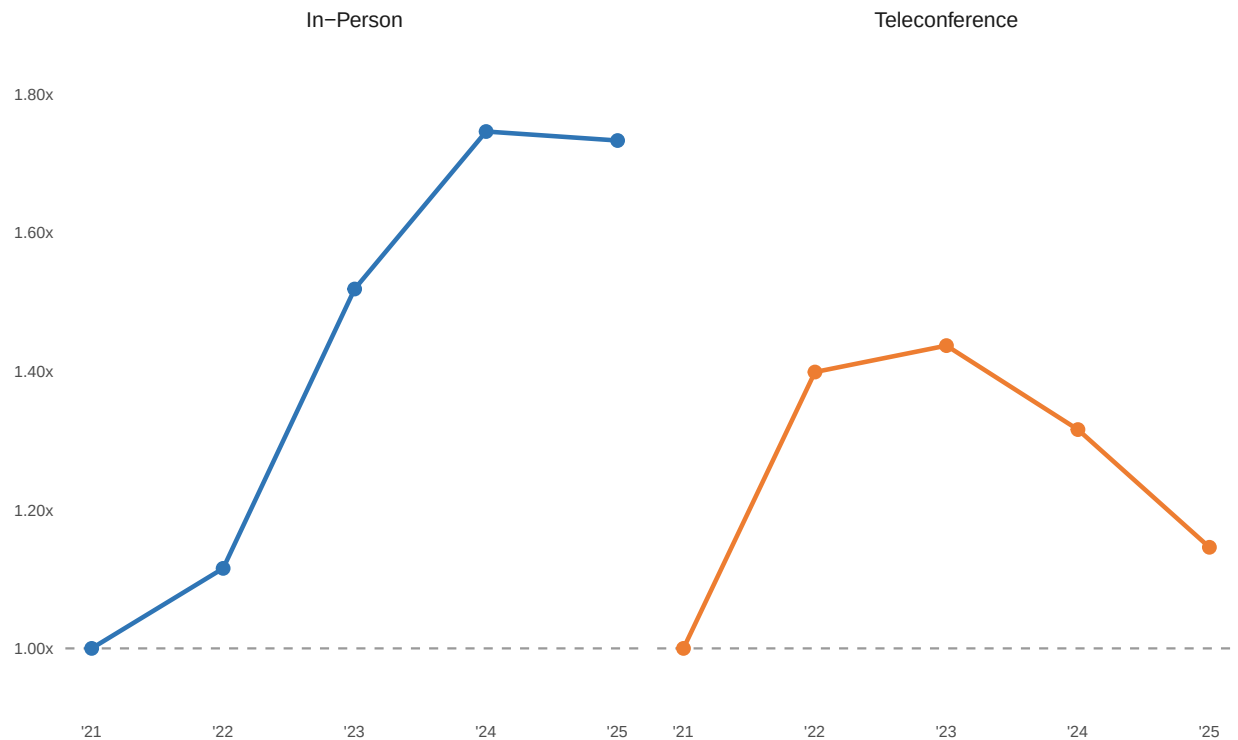


Figure 9: One-Day Service Modality Historical Trend

Tables

Table 1: Jury Yield Summary (2016–Present)

Summary of juror yield metrics for recent fiscal years.

Juror Yield Summary

	Total Summoned	Qualified & Available	Unavailable	Potentially Available	Yield %
2025	11.69M	5.16M	6.49M	11.69M	44.09
2024	11.55M	5.2M	6.35M	11.55M	45.04
2023	11.81M	5.07M	6.39M	11.81M	42.99
2022	10.63M	5M	5.63M	10.63M	47.05
2021	8.68M	3.98M	4.62M	8.6M	46.28
2020	8.88M	4.8M	4.07M	8.88M	54.12
2019	9.4M	4.08M	4.94M	9.02M	45.21
2018	9.38M	4.05M	4.89M	9.04M	44.83
2017	9.24M	3.88M	5.01M	9.24M	41.98
2016	7.98M	3.18M	4.46M	7.98M	39.84

Unavailable Prospective Jurors by Reason

	Excused	Disqualified	Dismissed	Undelivered	Failure to Appear	Postponed Out
2025	1.93M	1.14M	44K	773K	2.96M	563K
2024	1.91M	1.16M	45K	800K	2.78M	512K
2023	1.84M	1.23M	44K	837K	2.78M	533K
2022	1.71M	1.14M	43K	794K	2.09M	594K
2021	1.28M	864K	43K	675K	1.48M	759K
2020	1.54M	886K	28K	610K	1.42M	321K
2019	1.41M	1.07M	36K	734K	1.84M	489K
2018	1.43M	1.06M	44K	794K	1.82M	444K
2017	1.38M	1.1M	42K	800K	1.87M	445K
2016	1.27M	1.04M	40K	831K	1.46M	395K

Table 2: Juror Yield Summary by Year

Summary counts of prospective jurors by yield status across the past ten fiscal years.

Table 3: Unavailable Juror Subcategories

Counts of unavailable prospective jurors by reason across the past ten fiscal years.

Table 4: Utilization Pipeline Summary

Mean percentages at each stage of the jury utilization pipeline across the past five fiscal years.

Table 5: Panel Distribution by Case Type

Counts of prospective jurors sent for selection by case type across the past five fiscal years.

Jury Utilization Pipeline: Mean Percentages

	Told to Report (%)	Sent for Selection (%)	Panel Used (%)
2025	58.1	4.4	57.8
2024	32.4	49.6	58.8
2023	30.5	51.2	57.9
2022	28.3	51.4	60.0
2021	25.7	43.2	62.5

Panel Distribution by Case Type

	Felony	Misdemeanor	Civil	Other
2025	6K	3K	3K	90
2024	7K	2K	2K	903
2023	6K	3K	2K	191
2022	6K	2K	2K	152
2021	4K	1K	526	227

Table 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type

Counts of jurors sworn to service by case type across the past five fiscal years.

Table 7: One-Day Jury Service by Modality

Counts of one-day jurors by service modality across the past five fiscal years.

Sworn Jurors by Case Type

	Felony	Misdemeanor	Civil	Other
2025	3K	2K	2K	60
2024	3K	2K	1K	576
2023	3K	2K	1K	94
2022	2K	2K	1K	86
2021	1K	710	210	33

One-Day Jury Service by Modality

	In-Person	Teleconference
2025	786K	2.91M
2024	791K	3.34M
2023	688K	3.64M
2022	506K	3.55M
2021	453K	2.54M